

BOBBY BALL

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About Me

Senior Data/AI/ML professional, 24 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: Docker, Python, Airflow.

Education & Qualifications

Master, Data Science

Oakmere University | 2000 - 2002

Thesis: "Handling label noise in weakly supervised classification"

Relevant coursework: Statistical Learning, Data Mining, Experimental Design, Natural Language Processing

Bachelor, Electrical Engineering

Delft University of Technology | 1995 - 1999

Relevant Experience

Cloudflare — Staff AI Researcher

01/2019 - 08/2026

- » Developed an NLP classification system in Hugging Face reaching 96% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- » Built the feature store that 15 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.
- » Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.
- » Mentored 3 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.

Senior Machine Learning Engineer

Uber | 03/2013 - 01/2019

- » Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 12%.
- » Cut inference cost by 20% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on AWS.
- » Trained and deployed Hugging Face models serving 30M predictions per day at under 40ms p95.

AI Researcher, Nova Tech Group

01/2007 - 02/2013

- » Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 55% across 2 regions.
- » Built an end-to-end training pipeline on MLflow, cutting retraining from days to 6 hours.

Keystone Apps — Junior AI Researcher

05/2002 - 01/2007

- » Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 8 silent regressions before release.
- » Migrated ad-hoc notebooks into versioned Hugging Face pipelines with reproducible runs and tracked experiments.

Key Skills

Docker, Python, Airflow, Spark, Kafka, Databricks, MLflow, Snowflake, AWS, Scikit-learn, Hugging Face, SQL, Bash, Swift, Figma, React

Side Projects

Personal finance tracker

Self-hosted spend tracker built with React. Deliberately kept the data local rather than using a hosted service.

Certificates

AWS Certified Developer - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2019

Research Output

"Drift detection for production forecasting models" - co-authored conference paper, 2002.

"Drift detection for production forecasting models" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2002.

Language Skills

English — Bilingual

Arabic — C1